

Parts of a business e-mail

COMMUNICATION

LEVEL
Upper-intermediate

NUMBER
EN_BE_3202X

LANGUAGE
English

lingoda





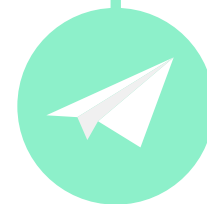
Goals

- Can recognise and understand the basic structure of a standard e-mail
- Can read a short e-mail and write a cohesive response

that makes sense!

An order.

Dear Student,
Are you ready to learn to write a
business e-mail?
Best of luck!
Your teacher.





Sending e-mails

Personal emails
Business emails.

**How often do you send
e-mails? Who do you
normally send them
to?**



Annoying e-mails

Is there anything that **annoys** you about e-mails you receive?





Recipients

When writing e-mails you will have noticed that there are three different places you can put a **recipient's address**. See below for when it is appropriate to use each one.

To:	Use this if you expect a reply from the recipients. You can write to multiple recipients.
Cc:	Use this if you do not expect a reply from the recipients. This is when an e-mail is more for information. You can write to multiple recipients.
Bcc:	Use this when you do not expect a reply from the recipients, and when you do not want the recipients to see who else received the e-mail. (The <i>B</i> stands for blind!).



The subject line

The **subject line** is extremely important in an e-mail and should **never be left blank**. Recipients decide whether to open an e-mail sooner or later based on the subject line.

Tips for a subject line

Make sure it is **concise** short and sweet

But, do not use one word descriptors e.g. help!

Summarise the content of the e-mail

Do not use all **capital letters**

Do not overuse punctuation, e.g. ???!





The structure of an e-mail

An e-mail should follow a **basic structure** so that your writing is clear and concise. The **components** of an e-mail are listed below.

Introduction	The first sentence should tell the recipient what the e-mail is going to be about.
Main Body	The details of the e-mail.
Ask/Action	Make a request of the recipient, or say what action should be taken moving forward
Closing	A polite thank you in advance to the recipient



An e-mail signature

At the end of your e-mails, after you have written a closing statement and your name, there should also be an **e-mail signature**. Here are some tips for a good one.

Social media links.

- 3 – 4 lines of text.
- Use an image, either a company logo or a picture of yourself.
- Do not include your e-mail address.
- Do not use inspirational quotations.

- Your name
- Title and company
- Phone number

Bob Hope

HR Manager, Area Solutions

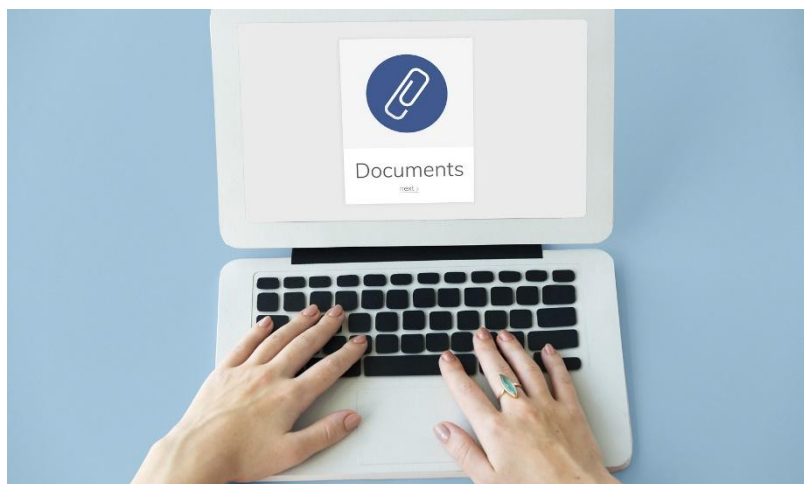
+44 123 4567 890



Attachments

Use **attachments** when you want to give lots of information in an e-mail.

- Always **mention the attachment** in the body of the e-mail.
- Use a document type which is easy for most people to open, e.g. **Word** or **PDF**.



Please find attached...



Cc and Bcc

Have you used the **Cc** or **Bcc** options in e-mails? When might you use them?





Write a subject line for each of these e-mail scenarios

Monthly meeting - date.

1. You are organising a team meeting next Wednesday at 4pm in the conference room. Each person will be giving their monthly report.

Report on Project Update.

2. You are working on a collaborative project with two colleagues. You want to update them on your progress, and get an update on theirs.

Reference Letter. Request for a reference letter.

3. You are leaving your job and you need a reference letter from your boss. She knows that you are leaving already.

Suggestions for improvements

Complaint about

4. You are writing to complain about a product that you bought which is faulty.

Product issue.....

Request for assistance.



Your e-mail signature



Design your e-mail signature with your teacher. What image would you use?



Attachments

What was the last attachment you sent? What about one you received?





The main body

The content of the **main body** of an e-mail will vary depending on its purpose, but there are **certain elements** which should always be there.

- Provide any relevant **background information**.
- Briefly **explain** the problem **or** situation, answering the questions: **Who? What? When? Where? How?**
- Keep it **short**. If you need to give lots of information, **attach a document** to the e-mail.



Ask/action

This is one of the **most important** parts of the e-mail, as you cannot expect the recipient to do what you want unless you **state explicitly** what that is.

- State the **action** you want carried out, or the **response** you wish to receive.
- Be clear about **who** needs to do **what**.
- Give a **deadline** for the action to be completed.



Font

Avoid italics and highlighting unless specifically warranted.

This is not a legible font.



Layout

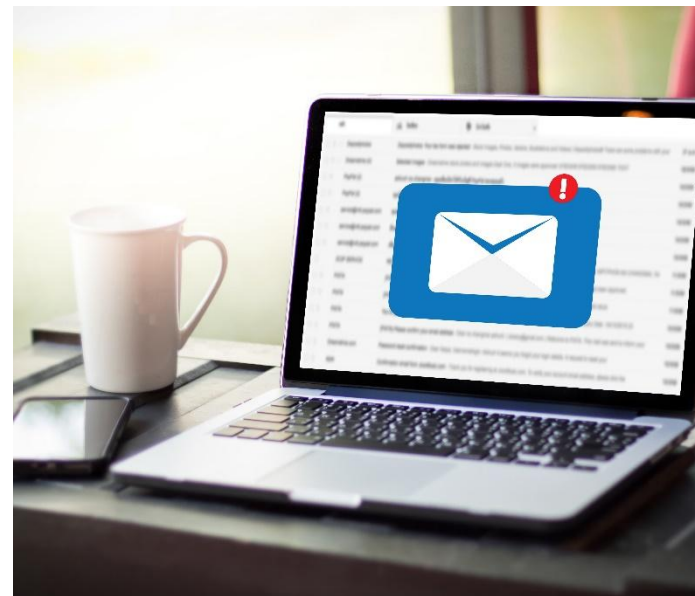
The **layout** of your e-mail is important. It creates an initial **impression** on the recipient, so the layout should make the e-mail look **simple** and **readable**.

Layout tips

Use a single column layout.

Always use paragraphs.

Leave a line between each paragraph.





Put the text of this e-mail in order

1

2

3

4

A

I have conducted the initial market research we agreed on and have compiled the results. The answers have given me a lot of interesting ideas for the placement of the advertisements, as well as the layout and colours which would appeal to our audience.

B

I would like to request a meeting with you to update you in more detail. I suggest Monday at 2pm. Please let me know if that works for you by this afternoon.

C

I am writing to give you an update on the new advertisement on which we have been working.

D

Kind regards,
John



e-mail example

- □ ×
To: bobhope@bobhope.com
Subject: Update on new advertisement
Dear Bob, I am writing to give you an update on the new advertisement on which we have been working. I have conducted the initial market research we agreed on and have compiled the results. The answers have given me a lot of interesting ideas for the placement of the advertisements, as well as the layout and colours which would appeal to our audience. Please find attached below a summary of the results. I would like to request a meeting with you to update you in more detail. I suggest Monday at 2pm. Please let me know if that works for you by this afternoon. Kind regards, John

Read through the e-mail example.



Situations when you need to send an e-mail

Below are some work situations when you need to communicate with other professionals. Have you ever been in any of these situations before?

You have finished writing a document for your boss. You would like her to read through your work and give you some feedback.

You are collaborating on a project with the finance department. Laura from finance has a spreadsheet of relevant numbers and you need to look at it to finish your work.

You are looking at a list of expectations from a client and some of them are contradictory. You want to arrange a meeting with them to explain this properly and help them figure out what they want.



Plan your e-mail

Make notes on the following in preparation for writing your own e-mail to arrange a meeting with a business colleague. If you're stuck for ideas, look at the situations on the previous slide for inspiration.

Where do you want to meet?

When do you want to meet?

Why do you need the meeting?

What is the meeting about?

Do you need directions to the meeting place?

Should you invite someone else?

A blank sheet of lined paper with a spiral binding on the left side, intended for taking notes.



e-mail writing activity

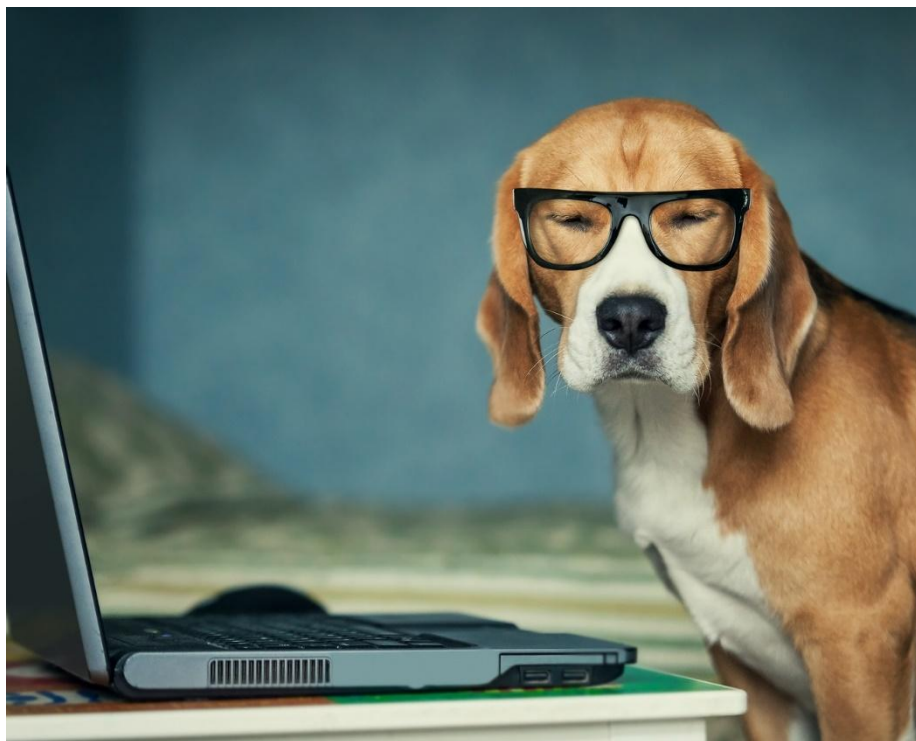
Using your notes, write an e-mail.

The diagram shows a window for writing an email. It has a title bar with three buttons: a minus sign, a square, and a cross. Below the title bar are three input fields. The first is labeled 'To:' and is empty. The second is labeled 'Subject:' and is empty. The third is a large text area with several horizontal lines for writing the body of the email.



Layout

Is the layout of an English e-mail similar to how you would structure an e-mail if you were writing in your language?





Reflect on the lesson

Take a moment to review any new **vocabulary, phrases, language structures** or **grammar points** you have come across for the first time in this lesson.

Review them with your teacher one more time to make sure you don't forget!





Answer key

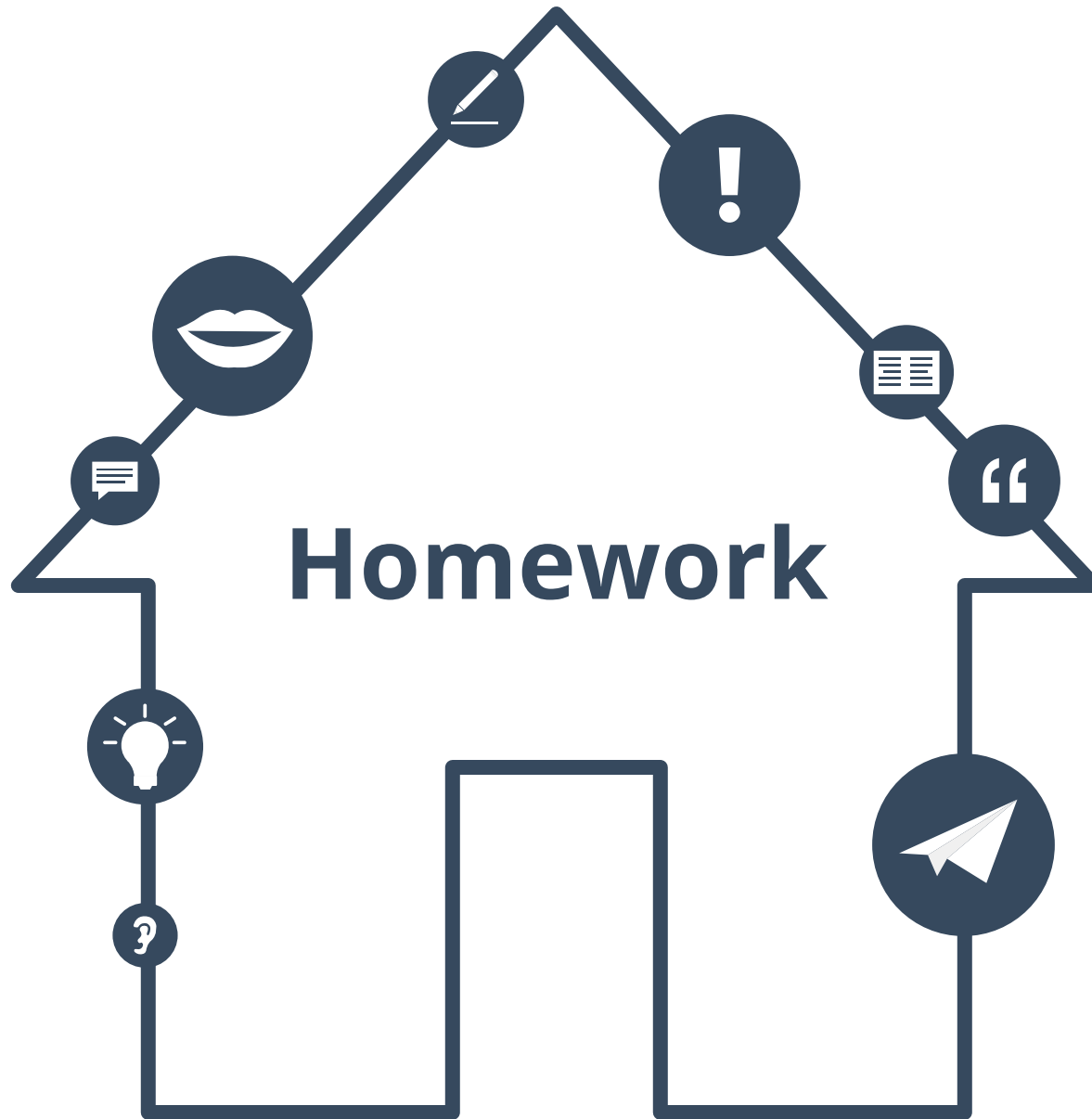
Exercise p. 12

(Sample answers)

1. Team Meeting – Wednesday at 4 PM (Monthly Reports Required)
2. Project Update: Progress & Next Steps
3. Request for Reference Letter – [your name]
4. Issue with Faulty Product – Request for Resolution

Exercise p. 19

1. C, 2. A, 3. B, 4. D





What do you remember?

How much can you remember about how to layout a business e-mail? Make notes here.

font

paragraphs

introduction

asking

main body

e-mail signature





Write an e-mail

Write an e-mail to your teacher telling him or her about the layout tips for writing an e-mail.

-□×

To:

Subject:

Dear _____,



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